STICLE

should be on your reading list



Flight of Talent

The term 'brain drain' has been used in the context of NRIs (non-resident Indians) since the 1990s, referring to highly-qualified individuals leaving the country in search of better prospects in America, the UK et al. In his new book, Sanjaya Baru (author of *The Accidental PM*) investigates why this phenomenon has accelerated in 21st century India, and evaluates the idea of 'soft power' versus the prospect of losing our precious human capital. Baru analyses macro-trends from the last decade and traces the evolution of the non-resident Indian into the 'non-returning Indian'.



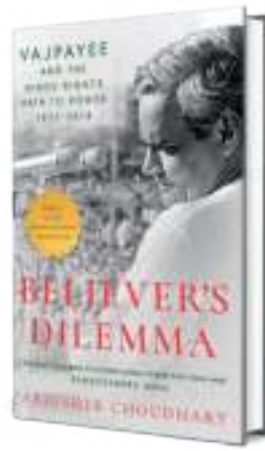
SARASWATI
By Gurnaik Johal
HACHETTE INDIA/ SERPENT'S TAIL
Pages: 384
Price: ₹699



THE HINDI HEARTLAND: A STUDY
By Ghazala Wahab
ALEPH BOOK COMPANY
PAGES: 528; PRICE: ₹ 999

REGIONAL DEEP DIVE

Journalist Ghazala Wahab takes a deep dive into the states that comprise the titular 'Hindi heartland' (Bihar, Jharkhand, Uttar Pradesh, Uttarakhand, Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh). Drawing from regional histories as well as ground-level interviews, this book explores the paradoxes and pressure points driving electoral politics in these states.



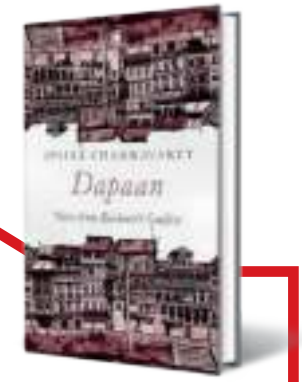
BELIEVER'S DILEMMA: VAJPAYEE AND THE HINDU RIGHT'S PATH TO POWER 1977-2018
By Abhishek Choudhary
PAN MACMILLAN INDIA
PAGES: 800; PRICE: ₹999

Yes, Prime Minister

This book is the concluding volume of Abhishek Choudhary's two-part study of former Indian prime minister Atal Behari Vajpayee (1924-2018), following the 2023 release *Vajpayee: The Ascent of the Hindu Right 1924-1977*. Through key moments from Vajpayee's political career, Choudhary traces the evolution of the Sangh Parivar and its growing influence in Indian politics and society since the 1970s.

PARADISE LOST

In the vein of indigenous oral-storytelling traditions, Ipsita Chakravarty interviews ordinary Kashmiris about living through decade after decade of armed conflict. Kashmiri folktales often begin with the word 'dapaan' ('it is said') and the title of the book alludes to storytelling practices indigenous to the region. These battle-hardened citizens have seen their stories being told by others from afar and, through this book, they reclaim the narrative, lived histories combining with mythology in constantly surprising ways.



DAPAAN: TALES FROM KASHMIR'S CONFLICT
By Ipsita Chakravarty
CONTEXT
PAGES: 320; PRICE: ₹699